

BA DOCUMENTATION PACK

E-Commerce Application — Inventory Dispute Resolution

Case Study by Karthika

Date: April 2026

Documents Included

1. Problem Statement Document
2. Stakeholder Register
3. Business Requirements Document (BRD)
4. Risk Register
5. Minutes of Meeting (MoM)

DOCUMENT 1 — PROBLEM STATEMENT DOCUMENT

Document Information

Field	Details
Project Name	E-Commerce App — Inventory Dispute Resolution
Document Type	Problem Statement Document
Prepared By	Karthika A, Business Analyst
Date	April 2026
Version	1.0
Status	Draft

1. Background

A client operates an e-commerce application that sells various products including clothing, shoes, skincare, and home appliances. The platform sources products directly from real, well-known brands and sellers and serves a significant customer base, particularly during seasonal offer periods.

2. Problem Statement

Certain product categories on the e-commerce platform are showing zero stock availability. This is not due to genuine stock shortage but due to an unresolved cost dispute between the client's warehouse manager and the seller, which has caused a breakdown in stock replenishment. The issue must be resolved within 30 days before the upcoming seasonal offer period begins, failing which significant revenue loss and customer dissatisfaction are expected.

3. Root Cause

- A cost dispute exists between the client's warehouse manager and the product seller
- Nature of dispute: disagreement on storage fees, delivery charges, or pricing margins (to be confirmed during elicitation)
- As a result, the seller has paused stock replenishment to the warehouse
- The app continues to show affected categories with zero inventory

4. Business Impact

Impact Area	Description	Severity
Revenue Loss	Zero stock in key categories = zero sales during offer season	High
Customer Experience	Customers cannot find or buy products they want	High

Impact Area	Description	Severity
Brand Reputation	Empty shelves reduce trust in the platform	Medium
Seller Relationship	Prolonged dispute may permanently damage seller partnership	Medium
Operational Risk	Offer season logistics disrupted without advance restocking	High

5. Objective

- Resolve the cost dispute between the warehouse manager and the seller within 30 days
- Restore stock levels across all affected product categories before the offer season begins
- Ensure no stockout disruption occurs during the peak offer period
- Establish a clear SLA or cost agreement to prevent recurrence

6. Scope

In Scope

- Affected product categories: clothing, shoes, skincare, home appliances
- Dispute facilitation between warehouse manager and seller
- Stock replenishment process
- App inventory accuracy

Out of Scope

- Platform technical changes or app redesign
- Changes to unaffected product categories
- Long-term vendor procurement strategy

7. Timeline

Milestone	Target Date
Problem Statement signed off	Week 1
Stakeholder meetings completed	Week 1
Dispute resolution agreed	Week 2–3
Stock replenishment initiated	Week 3
Inventory live on app	Week 4
Offer season begins	End of Month 1

DOCUMENT 2 — STAKEHOLDER REGISTER

Document Information

Field	Details
Project Name	E-Commerce App — Inventory Dispute Resolution
Document Type	Stakeholder Register
Prepared By	Karthika A, Business Analyst
Date	April 2026
Version	1.0

A Stakeholder Register identifies everyone involved in or affected by the project. As a Business Analyst, understanding each stakeholder's interest, influence, and position helps you communicate with the right person at the right time.

Stakeholder Register

Stakeholder	Role	Interest	Influence	Position	Communication Plan
Warehouse Manager	Client side — manages physical stock	Wants cost terms resolved in their favour; concerned about storage overheads	High	Resistant	Weekly 1:1 meeting; document all agreed points
Seller / Vendor	Supplies products to warehouse	Wants fair pricing and timely payment; has paused supply pending resolution	High	Resistant	Structured negotiation session; written agreement
Client Leadership / CEO	Approves resolution and budget	Wants offer season unaffected; concerned about revenue loss	Very High	Supportive	Escalation report; bi-weekly update
Procurement Team	Manages vendor contracts	Needs clear updated SLA / cost agreement	Medium	Neutral	Email updates; include in agreement review
Finance Team	Approves cost terms	Must validate that agreed costs are within budget	Medium	Supportive	Share cost proposal for sign-off
App Product Manager	Manages app inventory display	Needs confirmed stock data to update app listings	Medium	Supportive	Notify once stock confirmed; coordinate UAT

Stakeholder	Role	Interest	Influence	Position	Communication Plan
End Customers	Buy products on the app	Want products to be available and affordable	Low (indirect)	Affected	No direct communication; track via app reviews

Stakeholder Influence-Interest Matrix

Use this matrix to prioritise how much attention each stakeholder needs:

MANAGE CLOSELY (High Influence, High Interest) Warehouse Manager, Seller, Client Leadership	KEEP SATISFIED (High Influence, Low Interest) Finance Team
KEEP INFORMED (Low Influence, High Interest) App Product Manager, Procurement Team	MONITOR (Low Influence, Low Interest) End Customers

DOCUMENT 3 — BUSINESS REQUIREMENTS DOCUMENT (BRD)

Document Information

Field	Details
Project Name	E-Commerce App — Inventory Dispute Resolution
Document Type	Business Requirements Document (BRD)
Prepared By	Karthika A, Business Analyst
Reviewed By	TBD — Client Leadership
Date	April 2026
Version	1.0
Status	Draft — Pending Stakeholder Sign-off

1. Executive Summary

This BRD captures the business requirements needed to resolve the inventory dispute on the e-commerce platform and restore stock availability before the upcoming offer season. The resolution must be achieved within 30 days.

2. Business Objectives

- Resolve the cost dispute between warehouse manager and seller within 30 days
- Restore 100% stock availability across all affected product categories
- Ensure the platform is fully stocked and operational before offer season launch
- Establish a documented cost agreement to prevent future disputes

3. Business Requirements

Business Requirements describe WHAT the business needs to achieve — not HOW the system will do it.

Req. ID	Requirement	Priority	Source
BR-01	The warehouse manager and seller must reach a signed cost agreement within 21 days	Must Have	Client Leadership
BR-02	Stock levels for clothing, shoes, skincare and home appliances must be restored to pre-dispute levels	Must Have	App Product Manager
BR-03	The e-commerce app must show accurate real-time inventory for all affected categories	Must Have	App Product Manager
BR-04	A fallback supplier must be identified for each affected category in case resolution fails	Should Have	Procurement Team

Req. ID	Requirement	Priority	Source
BR-05	A 30-day interim SLA must be signed by both parties to enable restocking before offer season	Must Have	Client Leadership
BR-06	All cost agreement terms must be reviewed and approved by the Finance team before signing	Must Have	Finance Team
BR-07	A formal escalation protocol must be defined for future cost disputes to prevent recurrence	Could Have	BA Recommendation

4. Functional Requirements

Functional Requirements describe specific actions the solution must perform.

Req. ID	Functional Requirement	Priority
FR-01	The BA shall facilitate a structured negotiation session between warehouse manager and seller within Week 1	High
FR-02	Finance team shall validate and approve the proposed cost terms within 3 business days of receiving them	High
FR-03	Procurement team shall identify at least 2 alternative suppliers for each affected category within Week 2	Medium
FR-04	App Product Manager shall update inventory listings within 48 hours of confirmed stock delivery	High
FR-05	A signed copy of the cost agreement shall be stored in the project documentation repository	Medium

5. Non-Functional Requirements

Req. ID	Non-Functional Requirement	Type
NFR-01	Resolution process must be completed within 30 calendar days	Timeline
NFR-02	All stakeholder communication must be documented in writing (MoM)	Compliance
NFR-03	Cost agreement must comply with existing vendor contract terms	Legal
NFR-04	App inventory update must reflect actual warehouse stock within 24 hours of receipt	Performance

6. Assumptions

- Client leadership has authority to make final decisions on cost terms
- The seller is willing to negotiate and resume supply once terms are agreed
- The app's inventory system can be updated without technical development
- Finance team can review cost proposals within 3 business days

7. Constraints

- Resolution must occur within 30 days — non-negotiable due to offer season
- Budget for increased storage or delivery costs must be approved by Finance
- Existing vendor contracts may limit flexibility in renegotiating terms

8. Acceptance Criteria

Criteria	Measure of Success
Dispute resolution	Signed cost agreement by both warehouse manager and seller
Stock restoration	All affected categories show minimum par stock levels on app
App accuracy	Zero discrepancy between warehouse stock and app inventory display
Timeline	All of the above completed within 30 days

DOCUMENT 4 — RISK REGISTER

Document Information

Field	Details
Project Name	E-Commerce App — Inventory Dispute Resolution
Document Type	Risk Register
Prepared By	Karthika A, Business Analyst
Date	April 2026
Version	1.0

A Risk Register identifies potential things that could go wrong during the project, how likely they are, and what we will do about them. Every BA should maintain this document and review it weekly.

Risk Scoring Guide

Score	Likelihood	Impact
1	Rare — very unlikely to happen	Negligible — minimal effect on project
2	Unlikely — could happen but not expected	Minor — small delay or cost
3	Possible — might happen	Moderate — affects timeline or budget
4	Likely — probably will happen	Major — significant disruption
5	Almost Certain	Critical — project failure risk

Risk Score = Likelihood × Impact. Score 1–4: Low | 5–9: Medium | 10–25: High

Risk Register

Risk ID	Risk Description	Category	Likelihood	Impact	Score	Response	Mitigation Plan	Owner
R-01	Warehouse manager and seller fail to reach agreement within 30 days	Dispute	4	5	20 — HIGH	Escalate	Escalate to client leadership in Week 2 if no progress; bring in senior mediator	Client Leadership
R-02	Seller permanently withdraws supply from the platform	Vendor	2	5	10 — HIGH	Mitigate	Identify and onboard alternative suppliers in parallel (BR-04)	Procurement Team

Risk ID	Risk Description	Category	Likelihood	Impact	Score	Response	Mitigation Plan	Owner
R-03	Stock arrives too late for offer season launch	Timeline	3	5	15 — HIGH	Mitigate	Sign interim 30-day SLA by Week 2 to trigger early replenishment	BA + Warehouse Manager
R-04	Finance team delays approval of cost terms	Internal	3	3	9 — MEDIUM	Mitigate	Pre-brief Finance team in Week 1; set 3-day SLA for their review	Finance Team
R-05	App inventory not updated in time despite stock arriving	Technical	2	3	6 — MEDIUM	Mitigate	Assign App PM ownership of inventory update; test with UAT before go-live	App Product Manager
R-06	Dispute becomes public or affects brand reputation	Reputational	1	4	4 — LOW	Accept + Monitor	Monitor customer reviews and social media; prepare PR response if needed	Client Leadership
R-07	Agreed cost terms exceed budget	Financial	2	3	6 — MEDIUM	Mitigate	Finance team to set cost ceiling before negotiation begins	Finance Team

Risk Summary

Risk Level	Count	Risks
HIGH (10–25)	3	R-01, R-02, R-03
MEDIUM (5–9)	3	R-04, R-05, R-07
LOW (1–4)	1	R-06

DOCUMENT 5 — MINUTES OF MEETING (MoM)

A Minutes of Meeting (MoM) is a written record of what was discussed, decided, and assigned in a stakeholder meeting. It is one of the most important documents a BA maintains — it creates accountability and prevents disputes about what was agreed.

How to Write a MoM — Structure

Section	What to Include
Meeting Details	Date, time, location/platform, meeting number
Attendees	Names, roles, organisation of everyone present
Agenda	Topics that were planned to be discussed
Discussion Summary	Key points raised by each stakeholder
Decisions Made	What was agreed upon — specific and clear
Action Items	What needs to be done, by whom, and by when
Next Meeting	Date and agenda of the follow-up meeting

SAMPLE MoM — Meeting 1: Initial Stakeholder Discussion

Field	Details
Meeting No.	MoM-001
Date	Week 1 — April 7, 2026
Time	10:00 AM – 11:00 AM
Platform	Google Meet (Remote)
Prepared By	Karthika A, Business Analyst
Distributed To	All attendees listed below

Attendees

Name	Role	Organisation	Present
Karthika A	Business Analyst	Consulting Team	Yes
[Warehouse Manager Name]	Warehouse Manager	Client	Yes
[Client CEO / Leadership]	Decision Maker	Client	Yes

Name	Role	Organisation	Present
[Seller Representative]	Account Manager	Seller Organisation	Yes
[Procurement Lead]	Procurement Head	Client	Yes

Agenda

- Introduce the project and objectives
- Understand the root cause of the cost dispute from both sides
- Assess impact on inventory and offer season timeline
- Agree on next steps and assign responsibilities

Discussion Summary

1. Problem Overview — Presented by BA

The BA presented the current situation: affected product categories are showing zero stock on the app due to a supply pause linked to a cost dispute. The offer season begins in 30 days and restocking must begin within 2 weeks to meet this deadline.

2. Warehouse Manager's Position

- The current storage cost being charged by the seller is 15% above the contracted rate
- The warehouse manager has raised this issue twice via email but received no response
- Supply was paused by the seller 3 weeks ago

3. Seller Representative's Position

- The seller claims delivery costs have increased due to fuel price rises — the contracted rate no longer covers operational costs
- The seller is willing to resume supply if a revised rate is agreed
- The seller proposed a 7% cost increase on the current contract rate

4. Client Leadership's Position

- Leadership confirmed the offer season cannot be delayed
- Authorised the BA to facilitate negotiation and bring a proposed cost agreement for approval
- Finance team to be looped in within 48 hours

Decisions Made

#	Decision	Made By
D-01	BA will facilitate a structured negotiation session between warehouse manager and seller in Week 2	Client Leadership
D-02	An interim 30-day SLA will be drafted by BA and shared for review within 5 business days	BA + Procurement
D-03	Finance team will be briefed this week and given 3 business days to validate cost ceiling	Client Leadership

#	Decision	Made By
D-04	Procurement team to begin identifying alternative suppliers in parallel as risk mitigation	Procurement Lead

Action Items

Action ID	Action	Owner	Due Date	Status
A-01	Share MoM with all attendees for review and confirmation	Karthika A (BA)	April 8, 2026	Open
A-02	Brief Finance team and share cost dispute details	Client Leadership	April 9, 2026	Open
A-03	Draft interim 30-day SLA document	Karthika A (BA)	April 12, 2026	Open
A-04	Provide written response to BA on accepted cost ceiling range	Finance Team	April 11, 2026	Open
A-05	Identify 2 alternative suppliers per affected category	Procurement Lead	April 14, 2026	Open
A-06	Confirm availability for Week 2 negotiation session	Warehouse Manager + Seller	April 9, 2026	Open

Next Meeting

Field	Details
Meeting No.	MoM-002
Tentative Date	Week 2 — April 14, 2026
Purpose	Structured negotiation between warehouse manager and seller
Agenda Items	Review Finance cost ceiling Present interim SLA draft Negotiate revised cost terms Agree and sign

Note to Karthika: Always send the MoM within 24 hours of the meeting while discussion is still fresh. Ask attendees to confirm the minutes or raise corrections within 48 hours. This creates a formal, agreed record.